



Bajrang's provisional suspension revoked by disciplinary panel



A National Anti-Doping Disciplinary Panel has revoked wrestler Bajrang Punia's provisional suspension on technical grounds. Bajrang was handed a provisional suspension on April 23 for allegedly refusing to give his urine sample for dope testing at the selection trials for the Olympic qualifiers held at Sonipat on March 10. The Disciplinary Panel, comprising Sunny Choudhary, Dr. Rana Chengappa and Abantika Deka, on May 31 noted that "the notice of charge is yet to be issued to the athlete" and ordered "the provisional suspension of the athlete is revoked till NADA decides to issue the notice of charge to the athlete for the violation of anti-doping rules."

It is premature to go into the merits and demerits of the case, said the panel, adding if NADA decides to issue the notice of charge to the athlete then the matter will be listed for final hearing. Bajrang, who was previously approached by a NADA official for testing on December 13 with an expired kit, had submitted his explanation for refusing to give his sample because of his past experience and had said that he had not received any response to the email written by him to NADA over the issue.

Y. B. SARANGI

» INDIAN PLAYGROUND

SPORTOON



1 Grandmaster Arjun Erigaisi's strong showing in the French Team Chess Championship has helped him reach the fifth spot in the FIDE standings, making him the highest ranked Indian by live rating. Arjun has so far added 8.7 points to his tally, and with an ELO rating of 2769.7, he is only behind Magnus Carlsen of Norway, USA's Hikaru Nakamura and Fabiano Caruana and Ian Nepomniachtchi of Russia. He had briefly reached a career-high live rating of 2771.2 recently and is the only Indian since Viswanathan Anand to do so.

TEAM SPORTSTAR

2 The Ultimate Table Tennis (UTT) is set for an exciting 2024 season following its Coach Draft event, where each of the eight franchises selected both a foreign and an Indian coach. This year, the league has expanded to eight teams with the addition of Ahmedabad SG Pipers and Jaipur Patriots. The upcoming season, scheduled in Chennai from August 22 to September 7, promises to be an exciting chapter in UTT's journey. The franchise-based league is promoted by Niraj Bajaj and Vita Dani under the auspices of the Table Tennis Federation of India.

TEAM SPORTSTAR